

DON'T PRODUCE YOUR MONDAY REPORT THIS WEEK

Some businesses have confused being "data-driven" with producing data for data's sake — more reports, more dashboards, more spreadsheets analysing other spreadsheets.



THE THREE QUESTIONS BEFORE MONDAY

01 WHAT YOU PRODUCE

List every recurring report. Who reads it, and how long after the period it lands.

WHY IT MATTERS A buyer, and your own board, judge you on signal — not on volume.

02 WHAT DECISION IT ENABLES

For each report, name the decision that couldn't be made without it.

WHY IT MATTERS If the answer is none, the report is a habit, not a control.

03 WHAT HAPPENS IF YOU STOP

Skip it once. See how long it takes anyone to notice, or ask for it back.

WHY IT MATTERS Silence is the fastest audit of what your reporting actually does.

DATA-RICH OR DECISION-POOR?

SIGNS YOU'RE DROWNING IN DATA

A management pack running to 40 pages, most of it unread.

KPIs that measure activity, not money.

Numbers compiled, checked and circulated after they're already stale.

Sales, Ops and Finance each learning about their own numbers from a report, not from knowing.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

One dashboard: cash, risk, what changed, what happens next.

Departments that know their own numbers before month-end confirms them.

Real-time and automated where it can be, judged where it must be.

Every report traceable to a decision it exists to support.

**MONTH-END SHOULD CONFIRM WHAT GOOD LEADERS ALREADY KNOW.
IT SHOULDN'T REVEAL IT.**